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FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

CHEESECLOTH; WIPING PURPOSES

(REMNANTS AND SECONDS)

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers cheesecloth remnants and seconds of two types; bleached and unbleached and of two classes; long and short lengths.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Types and classes. The cheesecloth remnants shall be of the following types and classes (see 6.2).

Type I - Bleached
Type II - Unbleached

Class A - Short length
Class B - Long length

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

UU-C-282 - Chipboard.
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-F-320 - Fiberboard, Corrugated, and Solid, Sheet Stock (Container Grade), and Cut Shapes.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Shipment (Civil Agencies).
Fed. Std. No. 191 - Textile Test Methods.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

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(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

Laws and Regulation:

Rules and Regulations Under the Textile Fiber Products Identification Act 16 CFR 303.

(The Code of Federal Regulations (CFR) and the Federal Register (FR) are for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402. When indicated, reprints of certain regulations may be obtained from the Federal agency responsible for issuance thereof).

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. The cheesecloth shall be made of clean cotton. Reclaimed, discolored, or soiled material will not be acceptable.

3.2 Weave. The weave shall be plain.

3.3 Finish. The material shall be bleached or unbleached as specified.

3.3.1 Type I. Type I shall be bleached.

3.3.2 Type II. Type II shall be unbleached.

3.4 Width. The width shall be not less than 20 inches nor more than 50 inches.

3.5 Weight. The cloth shall weigh not less than 1/2 ounce nor more than 2-1/2 ounces per square yard.

3.6 Lengths.

3.6.1 Class A. The cloth length shall be at least 1 yard.

3.6.2 Class B. The cloth length shall be not less than 10 yards.

3.7 Fiber identification. The cloth shall be labeled or invoiced for fiber content in accordance with the Textile Fiber Products Identification Act.

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4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Certificate of compliance. Where certificates of compliance are submitted, the Government reserves the right to check test such items to determine the validity of the certification.

4.2 Inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated hereinafter.

4.2.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1 above, components and materials shall be tested in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings, and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase documents. In addition the supplier shall submit a certificate of compliance stating that cotton yarns were only yarns used in the weaving of the cloth. The supplier shall also submit a certificate of compliance stating that type I cheesecloth is bleached.

4.2.2 Examination of the end item. Cheesecloth of the same type and class, offered at the same time shall be considered a lot for the purpose of inspection. The sample unit shall be one sample cloth from one 50 pound (lb) bale or one 60 lb box (containing six 10 lb boxes). For the purpose of inspection no more than 10 yards of a sample unit need be examined.

TABLE I. Defects - Visual and Dimensional

Types I and II	Cloth defects 2 inches or larger including holes, cuts, or tears.
Classes A and B	Cloth length more or less than required.
	Cloth width more or less than required.
	Cloth weight more or less than required.
	Objectional odor.
	Cloth not bleached (type I).
	Cloth soiled or discolored.

4.2.3 Testing of the end item. The methods of testing specified in Fed. Std. No. 191, whenever applicable and as listed in table II shall be followed.

TABLE II. Test methods

Characteristics	Required paragraphs	Test method 1/
Cotton identification	3.1	1200 1/
Cheesecloth weight	3.5	5041
Bleached (type I)	3.3.1	1/

1/ Unless otherwise specified, a certificate of compliance shall be submitted and will be acceptable for stated requirement.

4.3 Visual and dimensional examination. Each lot of cheesecloth shall be examined for visual and dimensional defects (table III) using sample level S-2 and acceptable quality level (AQL) of 2.5 percent defective. Presence of any one defect in a sample unit shall constitute a defective.

4.3.1 Tests. Each lot of cheesecloth shall be tested in accordance with test methods specified in table II using sampling level S-2 and AQL of 2.5 percent defective. Failure of a sample unit to comply with any test shall constitute a defective.

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4.4 Inspection of preparation for delivery requirements. An inspection shall be made to determine whether the packaging, packing, and marking comply with the requirements of section 5 of this specification. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table III. For inspection of interior packaging, the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery, selected at random just prior to the closing operations. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 percent defective. Presence of any defect in a sample unit shall constitute a defective.

TABLE III. Classification of defects

Examine	Defects
Markings	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence or method of application.
Material	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate stapling, or distortion of container.
Contents	Quantity per container is more or less than required. Gross weight exceeds the requirements of the box specification.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. The cheesecloth shall be packaged in 10 pound quantities in a manner that will insure protection during shipment and safe delivery at destination, while complying with the common carrier rules as a minimum.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A.

5.2.1.1 Ten pound quantities. Six 10 pound quantities packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather resistant, grade W5C minimum, style OSC or FOL. The box shall be closed, waterproof sealed and reinforced in accordance with the appendix to PPP-B-636.

5.2.1.2 Fifty pound quantities. The 50 pound quantities shall be packed as follows: Two baling boards of corrugated fiberboard conforming to PPP-F-320, class weather resistant, grade W5C having length and width dimensions sufficient to permit scoring approximately 3 inches across the width dimension, shall be applied one on top and one beneath the cloth being prepared for baling. The boards shall be bent at the score lines to form top and bottom caps for the bales. The bales shall be compressed by machine and covered with burlap or osnaborg material which shall be secured in a manner that will prevent opening during shipment and storage. Each bale shall be further secured with not less than 3 straps applied in a manner to securely maintain the bale and prevent deformation in shipment and storage. Alternately, the fifty pound quantities shall be compressed and placed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather resistant, grade W5C minimum. The boxes shall be closed, sealed and strapped in accordance with the appendix to PPP-B-636, using a minimum of two straps.

5.2.2 Level B.

5.2.2.1 Ten pound quantities. Six 10 pound quantities packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic, grade 275 minimum, style OSC or FOL. The box shall be closed in accordance with method II of the appendix to PPP-B-636.

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5.2.2.2 Fifty pound quantities. The 50 pound quantities shall be packed as follows: Two baling boards of chipboard conforming to UU-C-282, 1/16 inch thick having length and width dimensions sufficient to permit scoring approximately 3 inches across the width dimension, shall be applied one on top and one beneath the cloth being prepared for baling. The boards shall be bent at the score lines to form top and bottom caps for the bales. The bales shall be compressed by machine and covered with burlap or osnaborg material which shall be secured in a manner that will prevent opening during shipment and storage. Each bale shall be further secured with not less than 3 straps applied in a manner to securely maintain the bale and prevent deformation in shipment and storage. Alternately, the 50 pound quantities shall be compressed and placed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic, grade 275 minimum. The boxes shall be closed and strapped in accordance with the appendix to PPP-B-636, using a minimum of two straps.

5.2.3 Level C. Cheesecloth packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed to assure carrier acceptance and safe arrival at destination in compliance with the National Motor Freight Classification rules or the Uniform Freight Classification rules.

5.3 Marking. Marking shall be in accordance with 5.3.1 or 5.3.2 as specified (see 6.2).

5.3.1 Civil agencies. Marking shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military agencies. Marking shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Cheesecloth remnants specified by this specification may be used for wiping or for other miscellaneous purposes.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type and class required (see 1.2.1).
(c) Quantity of cheesecloth per package and pack (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(d) Level of packing required (see 5.2).
(e) Whether civil or military marking is required (see 5.3).

Preparing Activity

GSA-FSS

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